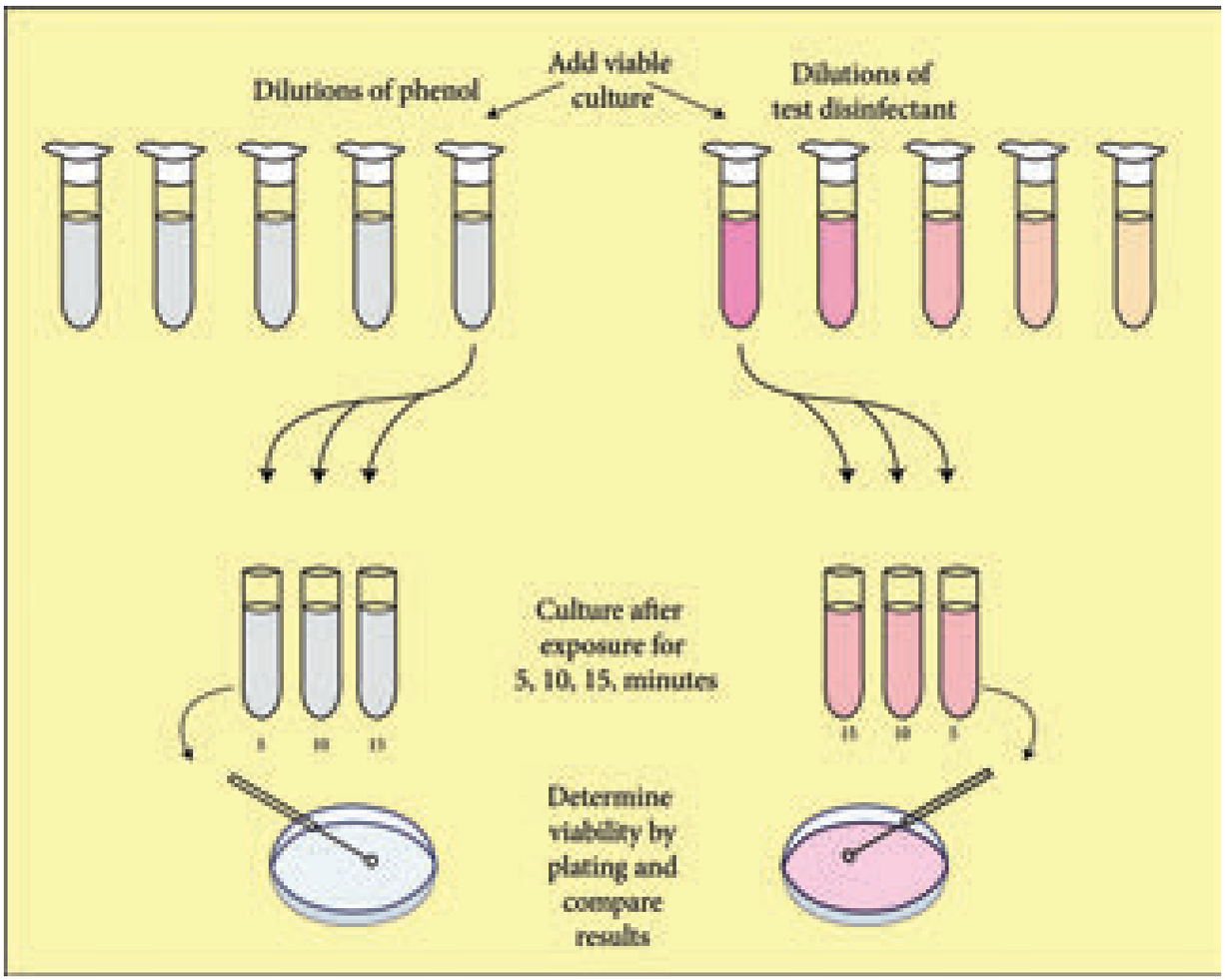


Figure 3.1: Phenol coefficient test

Phenol dilution of 1:90 showed at 5 minutes but no growth at 10 minutes Test Chemical dilution of 1:450 should growth at 5 minutes but not growth at 10 minutes phenol coefficient of test chemical = 450/90=5.

3.6 Antibiotics

The term 'antibiotic' was derived from 'antibiosis' which refers to the suppression of microorganisms due to secretion of toxic or inhibitory compounds by other microorganisms. Although antibiosis has been observed by many scientific workers fairly frequently towards the end of the nineteenth century, it was not until the discovery and development of Penicillin that a truly wide ranging search for antibiotics was initiated.



Antibiotics are not effective against viral infections such as the common cold.

Historical Development

The first chemotherapeutic agent, discovered by Paul Ehrlich, was Salvarsan, used to treat syphilis.

Alexander Fleming discovered the first antibiotic, penicillin, in 1929; its first clinical trails were done in 1940.

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